05 Deu · Deuteronomy

1 These are the words that Moses spoke to all Israel in the wilderness east of the Jordan—in the Arabah opposite Suph—between Paran and Tophel, Laban, Hazeroth, and Dizahab. [2] It is an eleven-day journey from Horeb to Kadesh-barnea by way of Mount Seir. [3] In the fortieth year, on the first day of the eleventh month, Moses proclaimed to the Israelites all that the LORD had commanded him concerning them. [4] This was after he had defeated Sihon king of the Amorites, who lived in Heshbon, and then at Edrei had defeated Og king of Bashan, who lived in Ashtaroth. [5] On the east side of the Jordan in the land of Moab, Moses began to explain this law, saying: [6] The LORD our God said to us at Horeb: "You have stayed at this mountain long enough." [7] Resume your journey and go to the hill country of the Amorites; go to all the neighboring peoples in the Arabah, in the hill country, in the foothills, in the Negev, and along the seacoast to the land of the Canaanites and to Lebanon, as far as the great River Euphrates. [8] "See, I have placed the land before you. Enter and possess the land that the LORD swore He would give to your fathers Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, and to their descendants after them." [9] At that time I said to you, "I cannot carry the burden for you alone." [10] The LORD your God has multiplied you, so that today you are as numerous as the stars in the sky. [11] May the LORD, the God of your fathers, increase you a thousand times over and bless you as He has promised. [12] But how can I bear your troubles, burdens, and disputes all by myself? [13] "Choose for yourselves wise, understanding, and respected men from each of your tribes, and I will appoint them as your leaders." [14] And you answered me and said, "What you propose to do is good."

[15] So I took the leaders of your tribes, wise and respected men, and appointed them as leaders over you—as commanders of thousands, of hundreds, of fifties, and of tens, and as officers for your tribes. [16] At that time I charged your judges: "Hear the disputes between your brothers, and judge fairly between a man and his brother or a foreign resident." [17] "Show no partiality in judging; hear both small and great alike. Do not be intimidated by anyone, for judgment belongs to God. And bring to me any case too difficult for you, and I will hear it." [18] And at that time I commanded you all the things you were to do. [19] And just as the LORD our God had commanded us, we set out from Horeb and went toward the hill country of the Amorites, through all the vast and terrifying wilderness you have seen. When we reached Kadesh-barnea, [20] I said: "You have reached the hill country of the Amorites, which the LORD our God is giving us." [21] "See, the LORD your God has placed the land before you. Go up and take possession of it as the LORD, the God of your fathers, has told you. Do not be afraid or discouraged." [22] Then all of you approached me and said, "Let us send men ahead of us to search out the land and bring us word of what route to follow and which cities to enter." [23] The plan seemed good to me, so I selected twelve men from among you, one from each tribe. [24] They left and went up into the hill country, and came to the Valley of Eshcol and spied out the land. [25] They took some of the fruit of the land in their hands, carried it down to us, and brought us word: "It is a good land that the LORD our God is giving us." [26] But you were unwilling to go up; you rebelled against the command of the LORD your God. [27] You grumbled in your tents and said, "Because the LORD hates us, He has brought us out of the land of Egypt to deliver us into the hand of the Amorites to be annihilated." [28] "Where can we go? Our brothers have made our hearts melt, saying: 'The people are larger and taller than we are; the cities are large, with walls up to the heavens. We even saw the descendants of the Anakim there.'" [29] So I said to you: "Do not be terrified or afraid of them!"

[30] The LORD your God, who goes before you, will fight for you, just as you saw Him do for you in Egypt [31] "and in the wilderness, where the LORD your God carried you, as a man carries his son, all the way by which you traveled until you reached this place." [32] But in spite of all this, you did not trust the LORD your God, [33] who went before you on the journey, in the fire by night and in the cloud by day, to seek out a place for you to camp and to show you the road to travel. [34] When the LORD heard your words, He grew angry and swore an oath, saying, [35] "Not one of the men of this evil generation shall see the good land I swore to give your fathers," [36] "except Caleb son of Jephunneh. He will see it, and I will give him and his descendants the land on which he has set foot, because he followed the LORD wholeheartedly." [37] The LORD was also angry with me on your account, and He said, "Not even you shall enter the land." [38] Joshua son of Nun, who stands before you, will enter it. Encourage him, for he will enable Israel to inherit the land. [39] And the little ones you said would become captives—your children who on that day did not know good from evil—will enter the land that I will give them, and they will possess it. [40] "But you are to turn back and head for the wilderness along the route to the Red Sea." [41] "We have sinned against the LORD," you replied. "We will go up and fight, as the LORD our God has commanded us." Then each of you put on his weapons of war, thinking it easy to go up into the hill country. [42] But the LORD said to me, "Tell them not to go up and fight, for I am not with you to keep you from defeat by your enemies." [43] So I spoke to you, but you would not listen. You rebelled against the command of the LORD and presumptuously went up into the hill country. [44] Then the Amorites who lived in the hills came out against you and chased you like a swarm of bees. They routed you from Seir all the way to Hormah. [45] And you returned and wept before the LORD, but He would not listen to your voice or give ear to you. [46] For this reason you stayed in Kadesh for a long time—a very long time.

2 Then we turned back and headed for the wilderness by way of the Red Sea, as the LORD had instructed me, and for many days we wandered around Mount Seir. [2] At this time the LORD said to me, [3] "You have been wandering around this hill country long enough; turn to the north" [4] and command the people: 'You will pass through the territory of your brothers, the descendants of Esau, who live in Seir. They will be afraid of you, so you must be very careful.' [5] Do not provoke them, for I will not give you any of their land, not even a footprint, because I have given Mount Seir to Esau as his possession. [6] "You are to pay them in silver for the food you eat and the water you drink.'" [7] Indeed, the LORD your God has blessed you in all the work of your hands. He has watched over your journey through this vast wilderness. The LORD your God has been with you these forty years, and you have lacked nothing. [8] So we passed by our brothers, the descendants of Esau, who live in Seir. We turned away from the Arabah road, which comes up from Elath and Ezion-geber, and traveled along the road of the Wilderness of Moab. [9] Then the LORD said to me, "Do not harass the Moabites or provoke them to war, for I will not give you any of their land, because I have given Ar to the descendants of Lot as their possession." [10] (The Emites used to live there, a people great and many, as tall as the Anakites. [11] Like the Anakites, they were also regarded as Rephaim, though the Moabites called them Emites.

[12] The Horites used to live in Seir, but the descendants of Esau drove them out. They destroyed the Horites from before them and settled in their place, just as Israel did in the land that the LORD gave them as their possession.) [13] "Now arise and cross over the Brook of Zered." So we crossed over the Brook of Zered. [14] The time we spent traveling from Kadesh-barnea until we crossed over the Brook of Zered was thirty-eight years, until that entire generation of fighting men had perished from the camp, as the LORD had sworn to them. [15] Indeed, the LORD's hand was against them, to eliminate them from the camp, until they had all perished.

[16] Now when all the fighting men among the people had died, [17] the LORD said to me, [18] "Today you are going to cross the border of Moab at Ar." [19] "But when you get close to the Ammonites, do not harass them or provoke them, for I will not give you any of the land of the Ammonites. I have given it to the descendants of Lot as their possession." [20] (That too was regarded as the land of the Rephaim, who used to live there, though the Ammonites called them Zamzummites. [21] They were a people great and many, as tall as the Anakites. But the LORD destroyed them from before the Ammonites, who drove them out and settled in their place, [22] just as He had done for the descendants of Esau who lived in Seir, when He destroyed the Horites from before them. They drove them out and have lived in their place to this day. [23] And the Avvim, who lived in villages as far as Gaza, were destroyed by the Caphtorites, who came out of Caphtor and settled in their place.)

[24] "Arise, set out, and cross the Arnon Valley. See, I have delivered into your hand Sihon the Amorite, king of Heshbon, and his land. Begin to take possession of it and engage him in battle." [25] "This very day I will begin to put the dread and fear of you upon all the nations under heaven. They will hear the reports of you and tremble in anguish because of you." [26] So from the Wilderness of Kedemoth I sent messengers with an offer of peace to Sihon king of Heshbon, saying, [27] "Let us pass through your land; we will stay on the main road. We will not turn to the right or to the left." [28] You can sell us food to eat and water to drink in exchange for silver. Only let us pass through on foot, [29] "just as the descendants of Esau who live in Seir and the Moabites who live in Ar did for us, until we cross the Jordan into the land that the LORD our God is giving us." [30] But Sihon king of Heshbon would not let us pass through, for the LORD your God had made his spirit stubborn and his heart obstinate, that He might deliver him into your hand, as is the case this day. [31] Then the LORD said to me, "See, I have begun to deliver Sihon and his land over to you. Now begin to conquer and possess his land." [32] So Sihon and his whole army came out for battle against us at Jahaz. [33] And the LORD our God delivered him over to us, and we defeated him and his sons and his whole army. [34] At that time we captured all his cities and devoted to destruction the people of every city, including women and children. We left no survivors. [35] We carried off for ourselves only the livestock and the plunder from the cities we captured. [36] From Aroer on the rim of the Arnon Valley, along with the city in the valley, even as far as Gilead, not one city had walls too high for us. The LORD our God gave us all of them. [37] But you did not go near the land of the Ammonites, or the land along the banks of the Jabbok River, or the cities of the hill country, or any place that the LORD our God had forbidden.

3 Then we turned and went up the road to Bashan, and Og king of Bashan and his whole army came out to meet us in battle at Edrei. [2] But the LORD said to me, "Do not fear him, for I have delivered him into your hand, along with all his

people and his land. Do to him as you did to Sihon king of the Amorites, who lived in Heshbon." [3] So the LORD our God also delivered Og king of Bashan and his whole army into our hands. We struck them down until no survivor was left. [4] At that time we captured all sixty of his cities. There was not a single city we failed to take—the entire region of Argob, the kingdom of Og in Bashan. [5] All these cities were fortified with high walls and gates and bars, and there were many more unwalled villages. [6] We devoted them to destruction, as we had done to Sihon king of Heshbon, utterly destroying the men, women, and children of every city. [7] But all the livestock and plunder of the cities we carried off for ourselves. [8] At that time we took from the two kings of the Amorites the land across the Jordan, from the Arnon Valley as far as Mount Hermon—

[9] which the Sidonians call Sirion but the Amorites call Senir— [10] all the cities of the plateau, all of Gilead, and all of Bashan as far as the cities of Salecah and Edrei in the kingdom of Og. [11] (For only Og king of Bashan had remained of the remnant of the Rephaim. His bed of iron, nine cubits long and four cubits wide, is still in Rabbah of the Ammonites.) [12] So at that time we took possession of this land. To the Reubenites and Gadites I gave the land beyond Aroer along the Arnon Valley, and half the hill country of Gilead, along with its cities. [13] To the half-tribe of Manasseh I gave the rest of Gilead and all of Bashan, the kingdom of Og. (The entire region of Argob, the whole territory of Bashan, used to be called the land of the Rephaim.)

[14] Jair, a descendant of Manasseh, took the whole region of Argob as far as the border of the Geshurites and Maacathites. He renamed Bashan after himself, Havvoth-jair, by which it is called to this day. [15] To Machir I gave Gilead, [16] and to the Reubenites and Gadites I gave the territory from Gilead to the Arnon Valley (the middle of the valley was the border) and up to the Jabbok River, the border of the Ammonites. [17] The Jordan River in the Arabah bordered it from Chinnereth to the Sea of the Arabah (the Salt Sea) with the slopes of Pisgah to the east. [18] At that time I commanded you: "The LORD your God has given you this land to possess. All your men of valor are to cross over, armed for battle, ahead of your brothers, the Israelites."

[19] But your wives, your children, and your livestock—I know that you have much livestock—may remain in the cities I have given you, [20] "until the LORD gives rest to your brothers as He has to you, and they too have taken possession of the land that the LORD your God is giving them across the Jordan. Then each of you may return to the possession I have given you." [21] And at that time I commanded Joshua: "Your own eyes have seen all that the LORD your God has done to these two kings. The LORD will do the same to all the kingdoms you are about to enter." [22] "Do not be afraid of them, for the LORD your God Himself will fight for you." [23] At that time I also pleaded with the LORD: [24] "O Lord GOD, You have begun to show Your greatness and power to Your servant. For what god in heaven or on earth can perform such works and mighty acts as Yours?" [25] "Please let me cross over and see the good land beyond the Jordan—that pleasant hill country as well as Lebanon!" [26] But the LORD was angry with me on account of you, and He would not listen to me. "That is enough," the LORD said to me. "Do not speak to Me again about this matter." [27] Go to the top of Pisgah and look to the west and north and south and east. See the land with your own eyes, for you will not cross this Jordan. [28] "But commission Joshua, encourage him, and strengthen him, for he will cross over ahead of the people and enable them to inherit the land that you will see." [29] So we stayed in the valley opposite Beth-peor.

4 Hear now, O Israel, the statutes and ordinances I am teaching you to follow, so that you may live and may enter and take possession of the land that the LORD, the God of your fathers, is giving you. [2] You must not add to or subtract from what I command you, so that you may keep the commandments of the LORD your God that I am giving you. [3] Your eyes have seen what the LORD did at Baal-peor, for the LORD your God destroyed from among you all who followed Baal of Peor. [4] But you who held fast to the LORD your God are alive to this day, every one of you. [5] See, I have taught you statutes and ordinances just as the LORD my God has commanded me, so that you may follow them in the land that you are about to enter and possess. [6] Observe them carefully, for this will show your wisdom and understanding in the sight of the peoples, who will hear of all these statutes and say, "Surely this great nation is a wise and understanding people." [7] For what nation is great enough to have a god as near to them as the LORD our God is to us whenever we call on Him? [8] And what nation is great enough to have righteous statutes and ordinances like this entire law I set before you today? [9] Only be on your guard and diligently watch yourselves, so that you do not forget the things your eyes have seen, and so that they do not slip from your heart as long as you live. Teach them to your children and grandchildren. [10] The day you stood before the LORD your God at Horeb, the LORD said to me, "Gather the people before Me to hear My words, so that they may learn to fear Me all the days they live on the earth, and that they may teach them to their children." [11] You came near and stood at the base of the mountain, a mountain blazing with fire to the heavens, with black clouds and deep darkness. [12] And the LORD spoke to you out of the fire. You heard the sound of the words, but saw no form; there was only a voice. [13] He declared to you His covenant, which He commanded you to follow—the Ten Commandments that He wrote on two tablets of stone. [14] At that time the LORD commanded me to teach you the statutes and ordinances you are to follow in the land that you are crossing the Jordan to possess. [15] So since you saw no form of any kind on the day the LORD spoke to you out of the fire at Horeb, be careful

[16] that you do not act corruptly and make an idol for yourselves of any form or shape, whether in the likeness of a male or female, [17] of any beast that is on the earth or bird that flies in the air, [18] or of any creature that crawls on the ground or fish that is in the waters below. [19] When you look to the heavens and see the sun and moon and stars—all the host of heaven—do not be enticed to bow down and worship what the LORD your God has apportioned to all the nations under heaven. [20] Yet the LORD has taken you and brought you out of the iron furnace, out of Egypt, to be the people of His inheritance, as you are today. [21] The LORD, however, was angry with me on account of you, and He swore that I would not cross the Jordan to enter the good land that the LORD your God is giving you as an inheritance.

[22] For I will not be crossing the Jordan, because I must die in this land. But you shall cross over and take possession of that good land. [23] Be careful that you do not forget the covenant of the LORD your God that He made with you; do not make an idol for yourselves in the form of anything He has forbidden you. [24] For the LORD your God is a consuming fire, a jealous God. [25] After you have children and grandchildren and you have been in the land a long time, if you then act corruptly and make an idol of any form—doing evil in the sight of the LORD your God and provoking Him to anger— [26] I call heaven and earth as witnesses against you this day that you will quickly perish from the land that you are crossing the Jordan to possess. You will not live long upon it, but will be utterly destroyed. [27] Then the LORD will scatter you among the peoples, and only a few of you will survive among the nations to which the LORD will drive you. [28] And there you will serve man-made gods of wood and stone, which cannot see or hear or eat or smell. [29] But if from there you will seek the LORD your God, you will find Him if you seek Him with all your heart and with all your soul. [30] When you are in distress and all these things have happened to you, then in later days you will return to the LORD your God and listen to His voice. [31] For the LORD your God is a merciful God; He will not abandon you or destroy you or forget the covenant with your fathers, which He swore to them by oath.

[32] Indeed, ask now from one end of the heavens to the other about the days that long preceded you, from the day that God created man on earth: Has anything as great as this ever happened or been reported? [33] Has a people ever heard the voice of God speaking out of the fire, as you have, and lived? [34] Or has any god tried to take as his own a nation out of another nation—by trials, signs, wonders, and war, by a strong hand and an outstretched arm, and by great terrors—as the LORD your God did for you in Egypt, before your eyes? [35] You were shown these things so that you would know that the LORD is God; there is no other besides Him. [36] He let you hear His voice from heaven to discipline you, and on earth He showed you His great fire, and you heard His words out of the fire. [37] Because He loved your fathers, He chose their descendants after them and brought you out of Egypt by His presence and great power, [38] to drive out before you nations greater and mightier than you, and to bring you into their land and give it to you for your inheritance, as it is this day. [39] Know therefore this day and take to heart that the LORD is God in heaven above and on the earth below; there is no other. [40] Keep His statutes and commandments, which I am giving you today, so that you and your children after you may prosper, and that you may live long in the land that the LORD your God is giving you for all time. [41] Then Moses set aside three cities across the Jordan to the east [42] to which a manslayer could flee after killing his neighbor unintentionally without prior malice. To save one's own life, he could flee to one of these cities: [43] Bezer in the wilderness on the plateau belonging to the Reubenites, Ramoth in Gilead belonging to the Gadites, or Golan in Bashan belonging to the Manassites. [44] This is the law that Moses set before the Israelites. [45] These are the testimonies, statutes, and ordinances that Moses proclaimed to them after they had come out of Egypt, [46] while they were in the valley across the Jordan facing Beth-peor in the land of Sihon king of the Amorites, who lived in Heshbon and was defeated by Moses and the Israelites after they had come out of Egypt. [47] They took possession of the land belonging to Sihon and to Og king of Bashan—the two Amorite kings across the Jordan to the east— [48] extending from Aroer on the rim of the Arnon Valley as far as Mount Siyon (that is, Hermon), [49] including all the Arabah on the east side of the Jordan and as far as the Sea of the Arabah, below the slopes of Pisgah.

5 Then Moses summoned all Israel and said to them: Hear, O Israel, the statutes and ordinances that I declare in your hearing this day. Learn them and observe them carefully. [2] The LORD our God made a covenant with us at Horeb. [3] He did not make this covenant with our fathers, but with all of us who are alive here today. [4] The LORD spoke with you face to face out of the fire on the mountain. [5] At that time I was standing between the LORD and you to declare to you the word of the LORD, because you were afraid of the fire and would not go up the mountain. And He said: [6] "I am the LORD your God, who brought you out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of slavery." [7] You shall have no other gods before Me. [8] You shall not make for yourself an idol in the form of anything in the heavens above, on the earth below, or in the waters beneath. [9] You shall not bow down to them or worship them; for I, the LORD your God, am a jealous God, visiting the iniquity

of the fathers on their children to the third and fourth generations of those who hate Me, [10] but showing loving devotion to a thousand generations of those who love Me and keep My commandments.

[11] You shall not take the name of the LORD your God in vain, for the LORD will not leave anyone unpunished who takes His name in vain. [12] Observe the Sabbath day by keeping it holy, as the LORD your God has commanded you. [13] Six days you shall labor and do all your work, [14] but the seventh day is a Sabbath to the LORD your God, on which you must not do any work—neither you, nor your son or daughter, nor your manservant or maidservant, nor your ox or donkey or any of your livestock, nor the foreigner within your gates, so that your manservant and maidservant may rest as you do.

[15] Remember that you were a slave in the land of Egypt, and that the LORD your God brought you out of there with a mighty hand and an outstretched arm. That is why the LORD your God has commanded you to keep the Sabbath day. [16] Honor your father and your mother, as the LORD your God has commanded you, so that your days may be long and that it may go well with you in the land that the LORD your God is giving you. [17] You shall not murder. [18] You shall not commit adultery. [19] You shall not steal. [20] You shall not bear false witness against your neighbor. [21] "You shall not covet your neighbor's wife. You shall not covet your neighbor's house or field, or his manservant or maidservant, or his ox or donkey, or anything that belongs to your neighbor."

[22] The LORD spoke these commandments in a loud voice to your whole assembly out of the fire, the cloud, and the deep darkness on the mountain; He added nothing more. And He wrote them on two tablets of stone and gave them to me. [23] And when you heard the voice out of the darkness while the mountain was blazing with fire, all the heads of your tribes and your elders approached me, [24] and you said, "Behold, the LORD our God has shown us His glory and greatness, and we have heard His voice out of the fire. Today we have seen that a man can live even if God speaks with him." [25] But now, why should we die? For this great fire will consume us, and we will die, if we hear the voice of the LORD our God any longer. [26] For who of all flesh has heard the voice of the living God speaking out of the fire, as we have, and survived? [27] "Go near and listen to all that the LORD our God says. Then you can tell us everything the LORD our God tells you; we will listen and obey." [28] And the LORD heard the words you spoke to me, and He said to me, "I have heard the words that these people have spoken to you. They have done well in all that they have spoken." [29] If only they had such a heart to fear Me and keep all My commandments always, so that it might be well with them and with their children forever. [30] Go and tell them: 'Return to your tents.' [31] "But you stand here with Me, that I may speak to you all the commandments and statutes and ordinances you are to teach them to follow in the land that I am giving them to possess." [32] So be careful to do as the LORD your God has commanded you; you are not to turn aside to the right or to the left. [33] You must walk in all the ways that the LORD your God has commanded you, so that you may live and prosper and prolong your days in the land that you will possess.

6 These are the commandments and statutes and ordinances that the LORD your God has instructed me to teach you to follow in the land that you are about to enter and possess, [2] so that you and your children and grandchildren may fear the LORD your God all the days of your lives by keeping all His statutes and commandments that I give you, and so that your days may be prolonged. [3] Hear, O Israel, and be careful to observe them, so that you may prosper and multiply greatly in a land flowing with milk and honey, just as the LORD, the God of your fathers, has promised you.

[4] Hear, O Israel: The LORD our God, the LORD is One. [5] And you shall love the LORD your God with all your heart and with all your soul and with all your strength. [6] These words I am commanding you today are to be upon your hearts. [7] And you shall teach them diligently to your children and speak of them when you sit at home and when you walk along the road, when you lie down and when you get up.

[8] Tie them as reminders on your hands and bind them on your foreheads. [9] Write them on the doorposts of your houses and on your gates.

[10] And when the LORD your God brings you into the land He swore to your fathers, to Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob, that He would give you—a land with great and splendid cities that you did not build, [11] with houses full of every good thing with which you did not fill them, with wells that you did not dig, and with vineyards and olive groves that you did not plant—and when you eat and are satisfied, [12] be careful not to forget the LORD who brought you out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of slavery. [13] Fear the LORD your God, serve Him only, and take your oaths in His name. [14] Do not follow other gods, the gods of the peoples around you. [15] For the LORD your God, who is among you, is a jealous God. Otherwise the anger of the LORD your God will be kindled against you, and He will wipe you off the face of the earth.

[16] Do not test the LORD your God as you tested Him at Massah. [17] You are to diligently keep the commandments of the LORD your God and the testimonies and statutes He has given you. [18] Do what is right and good in the sight of the LORD, so that it may be well with you and that you may enter and possess the good land that the LORD your God swore to give your fathers, [19] driving out all your enemies before you, as the LORD has said. [20] In the future, when your son asks, "What is the meaning of the decrees and statutes and ordinances that the LORD our God has commanded you?" [21] then you are to tell him, "We were slaves of Pharaoh in Egypt, but the LORD brought us out of Egypt with a mighty hand." [22] Before our eyes the LORD inflicted great and devastating signs and wonders on Egypt, on Pharaoh, and on all his household. [23] But He brought us out from there to lead us in and give us the land that He had sworn to our fathers. [24] And the LORD commanded us to observe all these statutes and to fear the LORD our God, that we may always be prosperous and preserved, as we are to this day. [25] "And if we are careful to observe every one of these commandments before the LORD our God, as He has commanded us, then that will be our righteousness."

7 When the LORD your God brings you into the land that you are entering to possess, and He drives out before you many nations—the Hittites, Girgashites, Amorites, Canaanites, Perizzites, Hivites, and Jebusites, seven nations larger and stronger than you— [2] and when the LORD your God has delivered them over to you to defeat them, then you must devote them to complete destruction. Make no treaty with them and show them no mercy. [3] Do not intermarry with them. Do not give your daughters to their sons or take their daughters for your sons, [4] because they will turn your sons away from following Me to serve other gods. Then the anger of the LORD will burn against you, and He will swiftly destroy you. [5] Instead, this is what you are to do to them: tear down their altars, smash their sacred pillars, cut down their Asherah poles, and burn their idols in the fire. [6] For you are a people holy to the LORD your God. The LORD your God has chosen you to be a people for His prized possession out of all peoples on the face of the earth. [7] The LORD did not set His affection on you and choose you because you were more numerous than the other peoples, for you were the fewest of all peoples.

[8] But because the LORD loved you and kept the oath He swore to your fathers, He brought you out with a mighty hand and redeemed you from the house of slavery, from the hand of Pharaoh king of Egypt. [9] Know therefore that the LORD your God is God, the faithful God who keeps His covenant of loving devotion for a thousand generations of those who love Him and keep His commandments. [10] But those who hate Him He repays to their faces with destruction; He will not hesitate to repay to his face the one who hates Him. [11] So keep the commandments and statutes and ordinances that I am giving you to follow this day.

[12] If you listen to these ordinances and keep them carefully, then the LORD your God will keep His covenant and the loving devotion that He swore to your fathers. [13] He will love you and bless you and multiply you. He will bless the fruit of your womb and the produce of your land—your grain, new wine, and oil, the young of your herds and the lambs of your flocks—in the land that He swore to your fathers to give you. [14] You will be blessed above all peoples; among you there will be no barren man or woman or livestock. [15] And the LORD will remove from you all sickness. He will not lay upon you any of the terrible diseases you knew in Egypt, but He will inflict them on all who hate you. [16] You must destroy all the peoples the LORD your God will deliver to you. Do not look on them with pity. Do not worship their gods, for that will be a snare to you.

[17] You may say in your heart, "These nations are greater than we are; how can we drive them out?" [18] But do not be afraid of them. Be sure to remember what the LORD your God did to Pharaoh and all Egypt: [19] the great trials that you saw, the signs and wonders, and the mighty hand and outstretched arm by which the LORD your God brought you out. The LORD your God will do the same to all the peoples you now fear. [20] Moreover, the LORD your God will send the hornet against them until even the survivors hiding from you have perished. [21] Do not be terrified by them, for the LORD your God, who is among you, is a great and awesome God. [22] The LORD your God will drive out these nations before you little by little. You will not be enabled to eliminate them all at once, or the wild animals would multiply around you. [23] But the LORD your God will give them over to you and throw them into great confusion, until they are destroyed. [24] He will hand their kings over to you, and you will wipe out their names from under heaven. No one will be able to stand against you; you will annihilate them. [25] You must burn up the images of their gods; do not covet the silver and gold that is on them or take it for yourselves, or you will be ensnared by it; for it is detestable to the LORD your God. [26] And you must not bring any detestable thing into your house, or you, like it, will be set apart for destruction. You are to utterly detest and abhor it, because it is set apart for destruction.

8 You must carefully follow every commandment I am giving you today, so that you may live and multiply, and enter and possess the land that the LORD swore to give your fathers. [2] Remember that these forty years the LORD your God led you all the way in the wilderness, so that He might humble you and test you in order to know what was in your heart, whether or not you would keep His commandments. [3] He humbled you, and in your hunger He gave you manna to eat, which neither you nor your fathers had known, so that you might understand that man does not live on bread alone, but on every word that comes from the mouth of the LORD. [4] Your

clothing did not wear out and your feet did not swell during these forty years. [5] So know in your heart that just as a man disciplines his son, so the LORD your God disciplines you. [6] Therefore you shall keep the commandments of the LORD your God, walking in His ways and fearing Him. [7] For the LORD your God is bringing you into a good land, a land of brooks and fountains and springs that flow through the valleys and hills; [8] a land of wheat, barley, vines, fig trees, and pomegranates; a land of olive oil and honey; [9] a land where you will eat food without scarcity, where you will lack nothing; a land whose rocks are iron and whose hills are ready to be mined for copper.

[10] When you eat and are satisfied, you are to bless the LORD your God for the good land that He has given you. [11] Be careful not to forget the LORD your God by failing to keep His commandments and ordinances and statutes, which I am giving you this day. [12] Otherwise, when you eat and are satisfied, when you build fine houses in which to dwell, [13] and when your herds and flocks grow large and your silver and gold increase and all that you have is multiplied, [14] then your heart will become proud, and you will forget the LORD your God who brought you out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of slavery. [15] He led you through the vast and terrifying wilderness with its venomous snakes and scorpions, a thirsty and waterless land. He brought you water from the rock of flint. [16] He fed you in the wilderness with manna that your fathers had not known, in order to humble you and test you, so that in the end He might cause you to prosper. [17] You might say in your heart, "The power and strength of my hands have made this wealth for me." [18] But remember that it is the LORD your God who gives you the power to gain wealth, in order to confirm His covenant that He swore to your fathers even to this day. [19] If you ever forget the LORD your God and go after other gods to worship and bow down to them, I testify against you today that you will surely perish. [20] Like the nations that the LORD has destroyed before you, so you will perish if you do not obey the LORD your God.

9 Hear, O Israel: Today you are about to cross the Jordan to go in and dispossess nations greater and stronger than you, with large cities fortified to the heavens. [2] The people are strong and tall, the descendants of the Anakim. You know about them, and you have heard it said, "Who can stand up to the sons of Anak?" [3] But understand that today the LORD your God goes across ahead of you as a consuming fire; He will destroy them and subdue them before you. And you will drive them out and annihilate them swiftly, as the LORD has promised you. [4] When the LORD your God has driven them out before you, do not say in your heart, "Because of my righteousness the LORD has brought me in to possess this land." Rather, the LORD is driving out these nations before you because of their wickedness. [5] It is not because of your righteousness or uprightness of heart that you are going in to possess their land, but it is because of their wickedness that the LORD your God is driving out these nations before you, to keep the promise He swore to your fathers, to Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. [6] Understand, then, that it is not because of your righteousness that the LORD your God is giving you this good land to possess, for you are a stiff-necked people. [7] Remember this, and never forget how you provoked the LORD your God in the wilderness. From the day you left the land of Egypt until you reached this place, you have been rebelling against the LORD. [8] At Horeb you provoked the LORD, and He was angry enough to destroy you.

[9] When I went up on the mountain to receive the tablets of stone, the tablets of the covenant that the LORD made with you, I stayed on the mountain forty days and forty nights. I ate no bread and drank no water. [10] Then the LORD gave me the two stone tablets, inscribed by the finger of God with the exact words that the LORD spoke to you out of the fire on the mountain on the day of the assembly. [11] And at the end of forty days and forty nights, the LORD gave me the two stone tablets, the tablets of the covenant. [12] And the LORD said to me, "Get up and go down from here at once, for your people, whom you brought out of Egypt, have corrupted themselves. How quickly they have turned aside from the way that I commanded them! They have made for themselves a molten image." [13] The LORD also said to me, "I have seen this people, and they are indeed a stiff-necked people." [14] "Leave Me alone, so that I may destroy them and blot out their name from under heaven. Then I will make you into a nation mightier and greater than they are." [15] So I went back down the mountain while it was blazing with fire, with the two tablets of the covenant in my hands. [16] And I saw how you had sinned against the LORD your God; you had made for yourselves a molten calf. You had turned aside quickly from the way that the LORD had commanded you.

[17] So I took the two tablets and threw them out of my hands, shattering them before your eyes. [18] Then I fell down before the LORD for forty days and forty nights, as I had done the first time. I did not eat bread or drink water because of all the sin you had committed in doing what was evil in the sight of the LORD and provoking Him to anger.

[19] For I was afraid of the anger and wrath that the LORD had directed against you, enough to destroy you. But the LORD listened to me this time as well. [20] The LORD was angry enough with Aaron to destroy him, but at that time I also prayed for Aaron. [21] And I took that sinful thing, the calf you had made, and burned it in the fire. Then I crushed it and ground it to powder as fine as dust, and I cast it into the stream that came down from the mountain. [22] You continued to provoke the LORD at Taberah, at Massah, and at Kibroth-hattaavah. [23] And when the LORD sent you out from Kadesh-barnea, He said, "Go up and possess the land that I have given you." But you rebelled against the command of the LORD your God. You neither believed Him nor obeyed Him. [24] You have been rebelling against the LORD since the day I came to know you. [25] So I fell down before the LORD for forty days and forty nights, because the LORD had said He would destroy you. [26] And I prayed to the LORD and said, "O Lord GOD, do not destroy Your people, Your inheritance, whom You redeemed through Your greatness and brought out of Egypt with a mighty hand." [27] Remember Your servants Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob. Overlook the stubbornness of this people and the wickedness of their sin. [28] Otherwise, those in the land from which You brought us out will say, 'Because the LORD was not able to bring them into the land He had promised them, and because He hated them, He has brought them out to kill them in the wilderness.' [29] "But they are Your people, Your inheritance, whom You brought out by Your great power and outstretched arm."

10 At that time the LORD said to me, "Chisel out two stone tablets like the originals, come up to Me on the mountain, and make an ark of wood." [2] "And I will write on the tablets the words that were on the first tablets, which you broke; and you are to place them in the ark." [3] So I made an ark of acacia wood, chiseled out two stone tablets like the originals, and went up the mountain with the two tablets in my hands. [4] And the LORD wrote on the tablets what had been written previously, the Ten Commandments that He had spoken to you on the mountain out of the fire on the day of the assembly. The LORD gave them to me, [5] and I went back down the mountain and placed the tablets in the ark I had made, as the LORD had commanded me; and there they have remained. [6] The Israelites traveled from Beeroth Bene-jaakan to Moserah, where Aaron died and was buried, and Eleazar his son succeeded him as priest.

[7] From there they traveled to Gudgodah, and from Gudgodah to Jotbathah, a land with streams of water. [8] At that time the LORD set apart the tribe of Levi to carry the ark of the covenant of the LORD, to stand before the LORD to serve Him, and to pronounce blessings in His name, as they do to this day. [9] That is why Levi has no portion or inheritance among his brothers; the LORD is his inheritance, as the LORD your God promised him. [10] I stayed on the mountain forty days and forty nights, like the first time, and that time the LORD again listened to me and agreed not to destroy you. [11] Then the LORD said to me, "Get up. Continue your journey ahead of the people, that they may enter and possess the land that I swore to their fathers to give them." [12] And now, O Israel, what does the LORD your God ask of you but to fear the LORD your God by walking in all His ways, to love Him, to serve the LORD your God with all your heart and with all your soul, [13] and to keep the commandments and statutes of the LORD that I am giving you this day for your own good?

[14] Behold, to the LORD your God belong the heavens, even the highest heavens, and the earth and everything in it. [15] Yet the LORD has set His affection on your fathers and loved them. And He has chosen you, their descendants after them, above all the peoples, even to this day. [16] Circumcise your hearts, therefore, and stiffen your necks no more. [17] For the LORD your God is God of gods and Lord of lords, the great, mighty, and awesome God, showing no partiality and accepting no bribe. [18] He executes justice for the fatherless and widow, and He loves the foreigner, giving him food and clothing. [19] So you also must love the foreigner, since you yourselves were foreigners in the land of Egypt. [20] You are to fear the LORD your God and serve Him. Hold fast to Him and take your oaths in His name. [21] He is your praise and He is your God, who has done for you these great and awesome wonders that your eyes have seen. [22] Your fathers went down to Egypt, seventy in all, and now the LORD your God has made you as numerous as the stars in the sky.

11 You shall therefore love the LORD your God and always keep His charge, His statutes, His ordinances, and His commandments. [2] Know this day that it is not your children who have known and seen the discipline of the LORD your God: His greatness, His mighty hand, and His outstretched arm; [3] the signs and works He did in Egypt to Pharaoh king of Egypt and all his land; [4] what He did to the Egyptian army and horses and chariots when He made the waters of the Red Sea engulf them as they pursued you, and how He destroyed them completely, even to this day; [5] what He did for you in the wilderness until you reached this place; [6] and what He did in the midst of all the Israelites to Dathan and Abiram, the sons of Eliab the Reubenite, when the earth opened its mouth and swallowed them, their households, their tents, and every living thing that belonged to them. [7] For it is your own eyes that have seen every great work that the LORD has done. [8] You shall therefore keep every commandment I am giving you today, so that you may have the strength to go in and possess the land that you are crossing the Jordan to possess, [9] and so that you may live long in the land that the LORD swore to your fathers to give them and their descendants, a land flowing with milk and honey.

[10] For the land that you are entering to possess is not like the land of Egypt, from which you have come, where you sowed your seed and irrigated on foot, like a vegetable garden. [11] But the land that you are crossing the Jordan to possess is a land of mountains and valleys that drinks in the rain from heaven. [12] It is a land for which

the LORD your God cares; the eyes of the LORD your God are always on it, from the beginning to the end of the year. [13] So if you carefully obey the commandments I am giving you today, to love the LORD your God and to serve Him with all your heart and with all your soul, [14] then I will provide rain for your land in season, the autumn and spring rains, that you may gather your grain, new wine, and oil.

[15] And I will provide grass in the fields for your livestock, and you will eat and be satisfied. [16] But be careful that you are not enticed to turn aside to worship and bow down to other gods, [17] or the anger of the LORD will be kindled against you. He will shut the heavens so that there will be no rain, nor will the land yield its produce, and you will soon perish from the good land that the LORD is giving you. [18] Fix these words of mine in your hearts and minds; tie them as reminders on your hands and bind them on your foreheads. [19] Teach them to your children, speaking about them when you sit at home and when you walk along the road, when you lie down and when you get up. [20] Write them on the doorposts of your houses and on your gates, [21] so that as long as the heavens are above the earth, your days and those of your children may be multiplied in the land that the LORD swore to give your fathers. [22] For if you carefully keep all these commandments I am giving you to follow—to love the LORD your God, to walk in all His ways, and to hold fast to Him— [23] then the LORD will drive out all these nations before you, and you will dispossess nations greater and stronger than you. [24] Every place where the sole of your foot treads will be yours. Your territory will extend from the wilderness to Lebanon, and from the Euphrates River to the Western Sea. [25] No man will be able to stand against you; the LORD your God will put the fear and dread of you upon all the land, wherever you set foot, as He has promised you. [26] See, today I am setting before you a blessing and a curse— [27] a blessing if you obey the commandments of the LORD your God that I am giving you today, [28] but a curse if you disobey the commandments of the LORD your God and turn aside from the path I command you today by following other gods, which you have not known. [29] When the LORD your God brings you into the land you are entering to possess, you are to proclaim the blessing on Mount Gerizim and the curse on Mount Ebal. [30] Are not these mountains across the Jordan, west of the road toward the sunset, in the land of the Canaanites who live in the Arabah opposite Gilgal near the Oak of Moreh? [31] For you are about to cross the Jordan to enter and possess the land that the LORD your God is giving you. When you take possession of it and settle in it, [32] be careful to follow all the statutes and ordinances that I am setting before you today.

12 These are the statutes and ordinances you must be careful to follow all the days you live in the land that the LORD, the God of your fathers, has given you to possess. [2] Destroy completely all the places where the nations you are dispossessing have served their gods—atop the high mountains, on the hills, and under every green tree. [3] Tear down their altars, smash their sacred pillars, burn up their Asherah poles, cut down the idols of their gods, and wipe out their names from every place. [4] You shall not worship the LORD your God in this way. [5] Instead, you must seek the place the LORD your God will choose from among all your tribes to establish as a dwelling for His Name, and there you must go. [6] To that place you are to bring your burnt offerings and sacrifices, your tithes and heave offerings, your vow offerings and freewill offerings, as well as the firstborn of your herds and flocks. [7] There, in the presence of the LORD your God, you and your households shall eat and rejoice in all you do, because the LORD your God has blessed you. [8] You are not to do as we are doing here today, where everyone does what seems right in his own eyes. [9] For you have not yet come to the resting place and the inheritance that the LORD your God is giving you.

[10] When you cross the Jordan and live in the land that the LORD your God is giving you as an inheritance, and He gives you rest from all the enemies around you and you dwell securely, [11] then the LORD your God will choose a dwelling for His Name. And there you are to bring everything I command you: your burnt offerings and sacrifices, your tithes and special gifts, and all the choice offerings you vow to the LORD. [12] And you shall rejoice before the LORD your God—you, your sons and daughters, your menservants and maidservants, and the Levite within your gates, since he has no portion or inheritance among you. [13] Be careful not to offer your burnt offerings in just any place you see; [14] you must offer them only in the place the LORD will choose in one of your tribal territories, and there you shall do all that I command you.

[15] But whenever you want, you may slaughter and eat meat within any of your gates, according to the blessing the LORD your God has given you. Both the ceremonially clean and unclean may eat it as they would a gazelle or deer, [16] but you must not eat the blood; pour it on the ground like water. [17] Within your gates you must not eat the tithe of your grain or new wine or oil, the firstborn of your herds or flocks, any of the offerings that you have vowed to give, or your freewill offerings or special gifts. [18] Instead, you must eat them in the presence of the LORD your God at the place the LORD your God will choose—you, your sons and daughters, your menservants and maidservants, and the Levite within your gates. Rejoice before the LORD your God in all you do, [19] and be careful not to neglect the Levites as long as you live in your land. [20] When the LORD your God expands your territory as He has promised, and you crave meat and say, "I want to eat meat," you may eat it whenever you want.

[21] If the place where the LORD your God chooses to put His Name is too far from you, then you may slaughter any of the herd or flock He has given you, as I have commanded you, and you may eat it within your gates whenever you want. [22] Indeed, you may eat it as you would eat a gazelle or deer; both the ceremonially unclean and the clean may eat it. [23] Only be sure not to eat the blood, because the blood is the life, and you must not eat the life with the meat. [24] You must not eat the blood; pour it on the ground like water. [25] Do not eat it, so that it may go well with you and your children after you, because you will be doing what is right in the eyes of the LORD. [26] But you are to take your holy things and your vow offerings and go to the place the LORD will choose. [27] Present the meat and blood of your burnt offerings on the altar of the LORD your God. The blood of your other sacrifices must be poured out beside the altar of the LORD your God, but you may eat the meat. [28] Be careful to obey all these things I command you, so that it may always go well with you and your children after you, because you will be doing what is good and right in the eyes of the LORD your God. [29] When the LORD your God cuts off before you the nations you are entering to dispossess, and you drive them out and live in their land, [30] be careful not to be ensnared by their ways after they have been destroyed before you. Do not inquire about their gods, asking, "How do these nations serve their gods? I will do likewise." [31] You must not worship the LORD your God in this way, because they practice for their gods every abomination which the LORD hates. They even burn their sons and daughters in the fire as sacrifices to their gods. [32] See that you do everything I command you; do not add to it or subtract from it.

13 If a prophet or dreamer of dreams arises among you and proclaims a sign or wonder to you, [2] and if the sign or wonder he has spoken to you comes about, but he says, "Let us follow other gods (which you have not known) and let us worship them," [3] you must not listen to the words of that prophet or dreamer. For the LORD your God is testing you to find out whether you love Him with all your heart and with all your soul. [4] You are to follow the LORD your God and fear Him. Keep His commandments and listen to His voice; serve Him and hold fast to Him. [5] Such a prophet or dreamer must be put to death, because he has advocated rebellion against the LORD your God, who brought you out of the land of Egypt and redeemed you from the house of slavery; he has tried to turn you from the way in which the LORD your God has commanded you to walk. So you must purge the evil from among you. [6] If your very own brother, or your son or daughter, or the wife you embrace, or your closest friend secretly entices you, saying, "Let us go and worship other gods" (which neither you nor your fathers have known, [7] the gods of the peoples around you, whether near or far, whether from one end of the earth or the other), [8] you must not yield to him or listen to him. Show him no pity, and do not spare him or shield him. [9] Instead, you must surely kill him. Your hand must be the first against him to put him to death, and then the hands of all the people.

[10] Stone him to death for trying to turn you away from the LORD your God, who brought you out of the land of Egypt, out of the house of slavery. [11] Then all Israel will hear and be afraid, and will never again do such a wicked thing among you. [12] If, regarding one of the cities the LORD your God is giving you to inhabit, you hear it said [13] that wicked men have arisen from among you and have led the people of their city astray, saying, "Let us go and serve other gods" (which you have not known), [14] then you must inquire, investigate, and interrogate thoroughly. And if it is established with certainty that this abomination has been committed among you, [15] you must surely put the inhabitants of that city to the sword. Devote to destruction all its people and livestock. [16] And you are to gather all its plunder in the middle of the public square, and completely burn the city and all its plunder as a whole burnt offering to the LORD your God. The city must remain a mound of ruins forever, never to be rebuilt. [17] Nothing devoted to destruction shall cling to your hands, so that the LORD will turn from His fierce anger, grant you mercy, show you compassion, and multiply you as He swore to your fathers, [18] because you obey the LORD your God, keeping all His commandments I am giving you today and doing what is right in the eyes of the LORD your God.

14 You are sons of the LORD your God; do not cut yourselves or shave your foreheads on behalf of the dead, [2] for you are a people holy to the LORD your God. The LORD has chosen you to be a people for His prized possession out of all the peoples on the face of the earth. [3] You must not eat any detestable thing. [4] These are the animals that you may eat: The ox, the sheep, the goat, [5] the deer, the gazelle, the roe deer, the wild goat, the ibex, the antelope, and the mountain sheep. [6] You may eat any animal that has a split hoof divided in two and that chews the cud. [7] But of those that chew the cud or have a completely divided hoof, you are not to eat the following: the camel, the rabbit, or the rock badger. [8] Although they chew the cud, they do not have a divided hoof. They are unclean for you, as well as the pig; though it has a divided hoof, it does not chew the cud. It is unclean for you. You must not eat its meat or touch its carcass.

[9] Of all the creatures that live in the water, you may eat anything with fins and scales, [10] but you may not eat anything that does not have fins and scales; it is unclean for you. [11] You may eat any clean bird, [12] but these you may not eat: the eagle, the bearded vulture, the black vulture, [13] the red kite, the falcon, any kind of kite, [14] any kind of raven, [15] the ostrich, the screech owl, the gull, any kind of hawk, [16] the

little owl, the great owl, the white owl, [17] the desert owl, the osprey, the cormorant, [18] the stork, any kind of heron, the hoopoe, or the bat.

[19] All flying insects are unclean for you; they may not be eaten. [20] But you may eat any clean bird. [21] You are not to eat any carcass; you may give it to the foreigner residing within your gates, and he may eat it, or you may sell it to a foreigner. For you are a holy people belonging to the LORD your God. You must not cook a young goat in its mother's milk. [22] You must be sure to set aside a tenth of all the produce brought forth each year from your fields. [23] And you are to eat a tenth of your grain, new wine, and oil, and the firstborn of your herds and flocks, in the presence of the LORD your God at the place He will choose as a dwelling for His Name, so that you may learn to fear the LORD your God always. [24] But if the distance is too great for you to carry that with which the LORD your God has blessed you, because the place where the LORD your God will choose to put His Name is too far away, [25] then exchange it for money, take the money in your hand, and go to the place the LORD your God will choose. [26] Then you may spend the money on anything you desire: cattle, sheep, wine, strong drink, or anything you wish. You are to feast there in the presence of the LORD your God and rejoice with your household. [27] And do not neglect the Levite within your gates, since he has no portion or inheritance among you. [28] At the end of every three years, bring a tenth of all your produce for that year and lay it up within your gates. [29] Then the Levite (because he has no portion or inheritance among you), the foreigner, the fatherless, and the widow within your gates may come and eat and be satisfied. And the LORD your God will bless you in all the work of your hands.

15 At the end of every seven years you must cancel debts. [2] This is the manner of remission: Every creditor shall cancel what he has loaned to his neighbor. He is not to collect anything from his neighbor or brother, because the LORD's time of release has been proclaimed. [3] You may collect something from a foreigner, but you must forgive whatever your brother owes you. [4] There will be no poor among you, however, because the LORD will surely bless you in the land that the LORD your God is giving you to possess as an inheritance, [5] if only you obey the LORD your God and are careful to follow all these commandments I am giving you today. [6] When the LORD your God blesses you as He has promised, you will lend to many nations but borrow from none; you will rule over many nations but be ruled by none.

[7] If there is a poor man among your brothers within any of the gates in the land that the LORD your God is giving you, then you are not to harden your heart or shut your hand from your poor brother. [8] Instead, you are to open your hand to him and freely loan him whatever he needs. [9] Be careful not to harbor this wicked thought in your heart: "The seventh year, the year of release, is near," so that you look upon your poor brother begrudgingly and give him nothing. He will cry out to the LORD against you, and you will be guilty of sin. [10] Give generously to him, and do not let your heart be grieved when you do so. And because of this the LORD your God will bless you in all your work and in everything to which you put your hand.

[11] For there will never cease to be poor in the land; that is why I am commanding you to open wide your hand to your brother and to the poor and needy in your land. [12] If a fellow Hebrew, a man or a woman, is sold to you and serves you six years, then in the seventh year you must set him free. [13] And when you release him, do not send him away empty-handed. [14] You are to furnish him liberally from your flock, your threshing floor, and your winepress. You shall give to him as the LORD your God has blessed you.

[15] Remember that you were slaves in the land of Egypt, and the LORD your God redeemed you; that is why I am giving you this command today. [16] But if your servant says to you, 'I do not want to leave you,' because he loves you and your household and is well off with you, [17] then take an awl and pierce it through his ear into the door, and he will become your servant for life. And treat your maidservant the same way. [18] Do not regard it as a hardship to set your servant free, because his six years of service were worth twice the wages of a hired hand. And the LORD your God will bless you in all you do. [19] You must set apart to the LORD your God every firstborn male produced by your herds and flocks. You are not to put the firstborn of your oxen to work, nor are you to shear the firstborn of your flock. [20] Each year you and your household are to eat it before the LORD your God in the place the LORD will choose. [21] But if an animal has a defect, is lame or blind, or has any serious flaw, you must not sacrifice it to the LORD your God. [22] Eat it within your gates; both the ceremonially unclean and clean may eat it as they would a gazelle or a deer. [23] But you must not eat the blood; pour it on the ground like water.

16 Observe the month of Abib and celebrate the Passover to the LORD your God, because in the month of Abib the LORD your God brought you out of Egypt by night. [2] You are to offer to the LORD your God the Passover sacrifice from the herd or flock in the place the LORD will choose as a dwelling for His Name. [3] You must not eat leavened bread with it; for seven days you are to eat with it unleavened bread, the bread of affliction, because you left the land of Egypt in haste—so that you may remember for the rest of your life the day you left the land of Egypt. [4] No leaven is to be found in all your land for seven days, and none of the meat you sacrifice in the evening of the first day shall remain until morning. [5] You are not to sacrifice the Passover animal in any of the towns that the LORD your God is giving you. [6] You must only offer the Passover sacrifice at the place the LORD your God will choose as a dwelling for His Name. Do this in the evening as the sun sets, at the same time you departed from Egypt.

[7] And you shall roast it and eat it in the place the LORD your God will choose, and in the morning you shall return to your tents. [8] For six days you must eat unleavened bread, and on the seventh day you shall hold a solemn assembly to the LORD your God, and you must not do any work. [9] You are to count off seven weeks from the time you first put the sickle to the standing grain.

[10] And you shall celebrate the Feast of Weeks to the LORD your God with a freewill offering that you give in proportion to how the LORD your God has blessed you, [11] and you shall rejoice before the LORD your God in the place He will choose as a dwelling for His Name—you, your sons and daughters, your menservants and maidservants, and the Levite within your gates, as well as the foreigner, the fatherless, and the widows among you. [12] Remember that you were slaves in Egypt, and carefully follow these statutes. [13] You are to celebrate the Feast of Tabernacles for seven days after you have gathered the produce of your threshing floor and your winepress.

[14] And you shall rejoice in your feast—you, your sons and daughters, your menservants and maidservants, and the Levite, as well as the foreigner, the fatherless, and the widows among you. [15] For seven days you shall celebrate a feast to the LORD your God in the place He will choose, because the LORD your God will bless you in all your produce and in all the work of your hands, so that your joy will be complete. [16] Three times a year all your men are to appear before the LORD your God in the place He will choose: at the Feast of Unleavened Bread, the Feast of Weeks, and the Feast of Tabernacles. No one should appear before the LORD empty-handed. [17] Everyone must appear with a gift as he is able, according to the blessing the LORD your God has given you. [18] You are to appoint judges and officials for your tribes in every town that the LORD your God is giving you. They are to judge the people with righteous judgment. [19] Do not deny justice or show partiality. Do not accept a bribe, for a bribe blinds the eyes of the wise and twists the words of the righteous. [20] Pursue justice, and justice alone, so that you may live, and you may possess the land that the LORD your God is giving you. [21] Do not set up any wooden Asherah pole next to the altar you will build for the LORD your God, [22] and do not set up for yourselves a sacred pillar, which the LORD your God hates.

17 You shall not sacrifice to the LORD your God an ox or a sheep with any defect or serious flaw, for that is detestable to the LORD your God. [2] If a man or woman among you in one of the towns that the LORD your God gives you is found doing evil in the sight of the LORD your God by transgressing His covenant [3] and going to worship other gods, bowing down to them or to the sun or moon or any of the host of heaven—which I have forbidden— [4] and if it is reported and you hear about it, you must investigate it thoroughly. If the report is true and such an abomination has happened in Israel, [5] you must bring out to your gates the man or woman who has done this evil thing, and you must stone that person to death. [6] On the testimony of two or three witnesses a man shall be put to death, but he shall not be executed on the testimony of a lone witness. [7] The hands of the witnesses shall be the first in putting him to death, and after that, the hands of all the people. So you must purge the evil from among you.

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